

The Mouth (oral Temperature)

This is a convenient, reliable and commonly used method, but should not be used if the patient is;

a) A child under 6 years of age

b) Unconscious, mentally confused or very nervous condition

c) Very weak, so that the mouth may full open

d) Having breathing difficulty or frequent cough

e) Having an injured of inflammed mouth.

Contra Indications

1. Oral temperature: Temperature should also not be taken by mouth soon after a hot drink (or) hot bath
2. Rectal: Rectal temperature is used for very ill patients, for infants and children. The reading is a little higher than oral when the temperature is taken by rectum
3. The Axilla: This is convenient when the temperature cannot be taken by mouth. It is less accurate and the reading will be a little lower than when taking by mouth. The axilla must be dried and the thermometer is placed. So that the bulb is in contact with both skin surfaces the arm should be held close to the chest.
4. Groin: This is a convenient site in children. The groin must be wiped dry and the thigh well flexed over the abdomen and held there.
5. Ear: It is also a convinient site for mentally disturbed patients. For assessment, digital thermometers are used.



5.5.3 Types of Thermometers

1) Mercury thermometers (Clinical thermometer)
2) Electronic thermometer
3) Temporal artery thermometer
4) Disposable thermometer

1) **Mercury thermometers (Clinical thermometer):** Clinical thermometers are meant for clinical purposes. It is developed for measuring the human body temperature. It is a long narrow

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